Subaru Liberty & Outback (Australia) Specification & Service Reference - Page 1/3

AUSTRALIAN AUTOMOTIVE ARCHIVE - TECHNICAL & SPECIFICATION DOSSIER

Make: Subaru | Model: Liberty & Outback | Australian Market Years: 1989-Present
Vehicle Type: Sedan / Wagon / All-Terrain Crossover | Segment: Medium / Large Car | Locally Built: No
Assembly Plants (AU):

1. MODEL OVERVIEW & AUSTRALIAN MARKET NOTES

The Subaru Liberty (Legacy globally) and Outback revolutionized Australian family and touring m
otoring. Spanning seven generations, the Liberty delivered rally-bred AWD performance with the
BC RS Turbo, twin-turbo B4, and 2003 Wheels Car of the Year winning BL/BP GT Spec.B, while the
lifted Outback pioneered the crossover wagon genre in 1996 and evolved into Australia's ultimat
e all-road adventure tourer.

First sold in Australia in 1989 (renamed Liberty due to Legacy Australia's veterans' charity tr
ademark), the Liberty won instant respect. Colin McRae and Possum Bourne campaigned the RS Turb
o in Australian and Asia-Pacific rallying. In 1996, the Outback created an entirely new market
segment. While the Liberty sedan bowed out in 2020 after 31 years and over 153,000 Australian s
ales, the Outback thrives with the 2.4-litre turbocharged XT.

SERIES / GENERATION: BC/BF (Liberty 1st Gen (inc. RS Turbo)) [1989-1994]

Body Styles: 4-door Sedan, 5-door Wagon | ANCAP: Untested
Introduced the modern EJ boxer engine family to Australia. The rally-bred RS Turbo AWD (147kW E
J20G) gave Possum Bourne and Colin McRae multiple Australian Rally Championship and APRC victor
ies.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- EJ22E: 2.2L (2212cc) Horizontally Opposed Boxer-44 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 100.0 kW / 181.0 N
- EJ20G-RS: 2.0L (1994cc) Horizontally Opposed Boxer-44 (Turbocharged Intercooled (Water-to-Air), Premi

Australian Badges / Trims:

- GX / Heritage: Drivetrain=FWD or AWD, Trans=5-speed manual with dual-range, 4-speed auto, AUD $24990-
- RS Turbo AWD: Drivetrain=Full-Time AWD with rear LSD, Trans=5-speed manual, AUD $38990-$41990, Fuel=1

Factory Configurations:

* Liberty RS Turbo AWD Sedan | 4-door Sedan | EJ20G-RS | 5-speed manual | AWD | 147.0kW/260.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: BD/BG (Liberty 2nd Gen & Original Outback) [1994-1999]

Body Styles: 4-door Sedan, 5-door Wagon, Outback All-Terrain Wagon | ANCAP: 3 stars
1994 Wheels Car of the Year (Liberty). In 1996, the Liberty Outback was launched in Australia w
ith 200mm ground clearance, two-tone cladding, and heavy-duty suspension, creating the crossove
r wagon category.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- EJ25D: 2.5L (2457cc) Horizontally Opposed Boxer-44 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 115.0 kW / 221.0 N

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Outback Wagon: Drivetrain=Symmetrical AWD (dual-range on manual), Trans=5-speed manual with dual-rang

Factory Configurations:

* Liberty Outback 2.5 Manual | Outback All-Terrain Wagon | EJ25D | 5-speed manual | AWD | 115.0kW/221.0

SERIES / GENERATION: BE/BH (Liberty 3rd Gen & B4 Twin Turbo) [1998-2003]

Body Styles: 4-door Sedan, 5-door Wagon, Outback Wagon | ANCAP: 4 stars

Multi-link rear suspension. Produced the 190kW sequential twin-turbo Liberty B4 sports sedan an
d the first six-cylinder 3.0L Outback H6.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- EJ208: 2.0L (1994cc) Horizontally Opposed Boxer-44 (Sequential Twin-Turbocharged Intercooled, Premium
- EZ30D: 3.0L (3000cc) Horizontally Opposed Flat-Six6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 154.0 kW / 282.0

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Liberty B4 Twin Turbo: Drivetrain=Symmetrical AWD with viscous center and rear LSD, Trans=5-speed man
- Outback H6 3.0: Drivetrain=VTD All-Wheel Drive, Trans=4-speed automatic, AUD $51990-$54990, Fuel=11.2

Factory Configurations:

* Liberty B4 Twin Turbo Manual | 4-door Sedan | EJ208 | 5-speed manual | AWD | 190.0kW/320.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: BL/BP (Liberty 4th Gen & Outback 3rd Gen (inc. GT Spec.B)) [2003-2009]

Body Styles: 4-door Sedan, 5-door Wagon, Outback Wagon | ANCAP: 5 stars

2003 Wheels Car of the Year winner. Frameless windows, lightweight aluminium body components, s
ilky 3.0R Spec.B with 6-speed manual, and the 194kW GT Spec.B.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- EJ255-BL: 2.5L (2457cc) Horizontally Opposed Boxer-44 (Twin-Scroll Turbocharged Intercooled, Premium
- EZ30R: 3.0L (3000cc) Horizontally Opposed Flat-Six6 (Naturally Aspirated, Premium Unleaded Petrol) |

Australian Badges / Trims:

- GT & GT Spec.B: Drivetrain=Symmetrical AWD with Torsen rear LSD, Trans=6-speed STI-derived manual, 5-
- Outback 2.5i & 3.0R: Drivetrain=Symmetrical AWD, Trans=5-speed manual with dual-range, 5-speed automa

Factory Configurations:

* Liberty GT Spec.B Manual Sedan | 4-door Sedan | EJ255-BL | 6-speed manual | AWD | 194.0kW/350.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: BM/BR (Liberty 5th Gen & Outback 4th Gen) [2009-2014]

Body Styles: 4-door Sedan, 5-door Wagon, Outback Wagon | ANCAP: 5 stars

Substantially larger cabin, framed door windows, 3.6L flat-six EZ36 engine (191kW), GT Premium
2.5L Turbo (195kW), and 2.0L Boxer Diesel.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- EZ36D: 3.6L (3629cc) Horizontally Opposed Flat-Six6 (Naturally Aspirated, Regular Unleaded Petrol) |

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Outback 3.6R: Drivetrain=VTD All-Wheel Drive, Trans=5-speed automatic with paddle shifters, AUD $4849

Factory Configurations:

* Outback 3.6R Premium Auto | Outback Wagon | EZ36D | 5-speed automatic | AWD | 191.0kW/350.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: BN/BS (Liberty 6th Gen & Outback 5th Gen) [2014-2020]

Body Styles: 4-door Sedan, Outback Wagon | ANCAP: 5 stars

Final generation of the Liberty sedan in Australia (retired in 2020 after 31 years). Outback co
ntinued as a standalone flagship crossover wagon.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- EZ36D-Gen2: 3.6L (3629cc) Horizontally Opposed Flat-Six6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 191.0 kW / 3

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Liberty 2.5i & 3.6R Sedan: Drivetrain=Symmetrical AWD, Trans=Lineartronic CVT, AUD $29990-$44490, Fue

Factory Configurations:

* Liberty 3.6R Sedan | 4-door Sedan | EZ36D-Gen2 | Lineartronic CVT | AWD | 191.0kW/350.0Nm

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SERIES / GENERATION: BT (Outback 6th Generation & XT Turbo) [2021-Present]

Body Styles: Outback All-Terrain Wagon | ANCAP: 5 stars

Built on the Subaru Global Platform. Reintroduced turbo power in 2023 with the 183kW/350Nm 2.4L FA24F Turbo in the Outback XT, featuring 2,400kg braked towing capacity and 11.6-inch portrait display.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- FA24F: 2.4L (2387cc) Horizontally Opposed Boxer-44 (Twin-Scroll Turbocharged Intercooled, Premium Unl

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Sport XT & Touring XT Turbo: Drivetrain=Symmetrical AWD with Dual-Function X-Mode, Trans=Lineartronic

Factory Configurations:

* Outback Touring XT Turbo | Outback All-Terrain Wagon | FA24F | Lineartronic CVT | AWD | 183.0kW/350.0